

Minor Pentatonic Scales

Trombone/Baritone

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Bb Minor Pentatonic B Minor Pentatonic C Minor Pentatonic

8 C# Minor Pentatonic D Minor Pentatonic

15 Eb Minor Pentatonic E Minor Pentatonic

22 F Minor Pentatonic F# Minor Pentatonic G Minor Pentatonic

30 Ab Minor Pentatonic A Minor Pentatonic

Quick info:

Minor pentatonic scales are called as such because they contain five notes (plus an octave) and are based off of **Natural Minor** scales. From what I understand, these scales tend to be the first ones that guitar players will learn, even before Major Pentatonics. Similarly to their major counterpart, they're incredibly useful to use over minor chords.

To form one of these scales, you want to take a **Natural Minor** (not a **Harmonic Minor**) scale and remove the **2nd** and **6th** notes from the scale; the notes that are left will form the Minor Pentatonic version of that Natural Minor scale. Let's use C Minor as an example:

A C Natural Minor scale contains the notes "C, D, Eb, F, G, Ab, Bb," and the octave ("C"). The 2nd and 6th notes are "D" and "Ab" respectively. If we take those two notes out, we're left with "C, Eb, F, G, Bb," and "C". If you look at C Minor Pentatonic written above (the 1st scale on this page), you'll notice that it matches the notes that we're left with after removing the 2nd and 6th scale degrees from the C Natural Minor scale.

If you take the Natural Minor Scale worksheet and remove the 2nd and 6th notes from all the scales on that sheet, then you should end up with all the minor pentatonics that are written out here. For reasons that I won't get into right now, you might end up with some different names (Eb instead of D#), but as long as you remember the concept of enharmonics, you should still get the correct scales.

Similarly to Major Pentatonics, the name "Minor Pentatonics" can be a bit ambiguous, but when people talk about "Minor Pentatonic Scales", they're usually referring to the ones listed above. There are other scales out there that could be classified as "Minor Pentatonic Scales", but most people will use that name to talk about these ones. Another name you might hear used for this type of scale is "Natural Minor Pentatonic", but even that term can also refer to different scales as well.

Learning both your Major and Minor Pentatonic scales will greatly prepare you for learning your blues scales. If you're interested in jazz music at all, blues scales will be fairly important to you, and those scales are based off of Pentatonic scales.